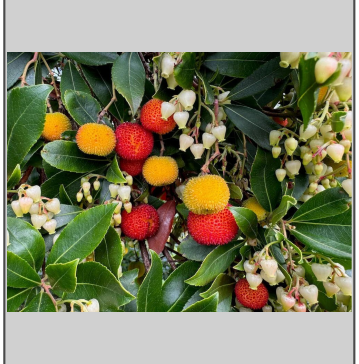
Arbutus unedo 'Compacta'

Compact strawberry tree, Dwarf strawberry tree

Family: Ericaceae



HABIT



OTHER



OTHER





FLOWER / FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Small tree or large shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Typically 5–10 ft (1.5–3 m) tall and wide. Compact, dense or Some list 6–8 ft in 10 years, eventually ~10 ft; RHS notes ~2.5 m

Sun

Water

Soil
Well-drained. Tolerates clay, loam, sand, poor/lean soils, acidic to alkaline. Prefers fertile, humus-rich.
Avoid waterlogged ground

Zone 8a
Hardy Zones 7–10. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a with good drainage. Protect young plants from hard freezes. Excellent heat and drought tolerance once established.
Shelter from cold drying winds recommended

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment
Plant in well-drained soil with shelter from cold winds. Minimal pruning (group 1). Water to establish. Once established, low water. Slow to moderate growth. Suitable for containers, coastal, Mediterranean, wildlife gardens

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Cultivar of *Arbutus unedo*, native to Mediterranean (southern Europe, Ireland). Garden selection

Form
Evergreen shrub or small multi-stem tree. Dense, rounded to upright, compact habit. Slower growth than species. Popular compact form of the strawberry tree.
Flowers and fruit often appear together

Foliage
Evergreen, mid-green, leathery, oval leaves.
Year-round interest

Flowers and fruit
Small, urn-shaped, creamy-white to pinkish flowers in clusters. Fall to winter (September–December). Often concurrent with fruit; Round, knobby, orange-red "strawberry-like" fruits. Edible (tangy). Attract birds

Bark
Red-brown, attractive, often exfoliating. Year-round interest

HEALTH

Health
May be susceptible to aphids, arbutus leaf spot, honey fungus. Generally low-maintenance and disease-resistant when well-sited. Young plants frost-tender

Symptoms
None stated